City of Saint Paul

Meeting Minutes

City Council

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, August 19, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:30 PM

Present 5 - Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

Absent 2 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker and Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-51 Amending the 2026 spending and financing budgets in the Department of Public Works Asphalt Plant Accounting Units to fund the purchase of a Skid Steer Loader.

Received and Filed

2 AO 26-56 Authorizing the Police Department to reallocate grant fund and activity budget to more accurately reflect activity for the 2023 Port Security Grant.

Received and Filed

3 AO 26-57 Authorizing the Saint Paul Public Library Agency to reallocate the budget to more accurately record revenue and expenditures for the department special project fund for 2026.

Received and Filed

4 AO 26-58 Establishing Seventeen (17) New Projects Through the STAR Economic Development Program as Adopted by City Council Resolution 26-405.

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted

Yea: 5 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 2 - Councilmember Noecker and Councilmember Kim

5 RES 26-1225 Approving the City's cost of providing Securing and/or Emergency Boarding services during June 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for September 15, 2026 and City Council public hearing for October 14, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2614B, Assessment No. 268120)

Adopted

6 RES 26-1235 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for benefits, costs and expenses for the Seventh Place Mall operation and maintenance costs for 2025. File No. 18428-25, Assessment No. 257200.

Adopted

7 RES 26-1236 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for benefits, costs and expenses for the Seventh Place Mall operation and maintenance costs for 2026. File No. 18428-26, Assessment No. 267200.

Adopted

8 RES 26-1261 Authorizing payment in the amount of $26,625.00 in full and final settlement of the claim of Emily Trudeau.

Adopted

9 RES 26-1272 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council Public Hearing to ratify the assessment for benefits, costs, and expenses for the Grand/Snelling parking lot operation and maintenance for 2027. File No. 18746-26, Assessment No. 267202.

Adopted

10 RES 26-1281 Changing the rate of pay for Assistant Chief of Police from Grade 035 to the new Grade 38C of the Employee Group 17, Non-Represented City Managers.

Laid over to August 26, 2026

11 RES 26-1294 Changing the rate of pay for Senior Zoo Keeper, EG 10, Manual and Maintenance Supervisors.

Laid over to August 26, 2026

12 RES 26-1301 Directing the Department of Safety and Inspections to proceed with adverse action and the imposition of a $500 matrix penalty and amended license conditions against Richard A Defoe Entertainment Inc d/b/a Wilebskis Blues Saloon (License ID #0096027) for the premises located at 1638 Rice St.

Adopted

13 RES 26-1302 Authorizing the Fire Department to pay for all costs associated with the Fire Explorers program training and events in 2026.

Adopted

14 RES 26-1315 Authorizing the Police Department to submit a grant application to the FY 2027 Enforcement Grant Program from the Office of Traffic Safety of the Minnesota Department of Public Safety.

Adopted

15 RES 26-1317 Approving the use of grant funds through the Ward 7 Neighborhood Star Year-Round for Champion Investments LLC

Adopted

16 RES 26-1319 Approving the use of grants funds through the Ward 7 Neighborhood Star Year-Round Program for More Doors LLC

Adopted

17 RES 26-1327 Approving and Authorizing the Non-use of a Project Labor Agreement on a Single-family Housing Redevelopment Project at 47 Douglas Street.

Adopted

18 RES 26-1330 Approving and Authorizing the Non-use of a Project Labor Agreement on a Duplex Housing Development Project at 1087 Ross Avenue.

Adopted

19 RES 26-1335 Approving the application for change of ownership to the Liquor On Sale (100 seats or less) and Liquor On Sale - Sunday licenses (License ID #DSIBLLIQ-001090-2026) now held by El Jalisco Grill and Bar Mexican Restaurant No 3 Inc d/b/a El Jalisco Grill and Bar Mexican Restaurant No 3 for the premises located at 296 Larpenteur Ave. E.

Adopted

20 RES 26-1336 Approving a Liquor On Sale - 181-290 seats, Liquor On Sale - Sunday, Liquor Outdoor Service Area (Patio), and Entertainment (B) licenses (License ID #DSIBLLIQ- 001555-2026) new location application by Avalon LLC d/b/a Avalon for the premises located at 80 4th St. W.

Adopted

21 RES 26-1337 Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreement (January 1, 2026 - December 31, 2028) between the City of Saint Paul and the Classified Confidential Employees Association.

Laid over to August 26, 2026

ROLL CALL

Present 6 - Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

Absent 1 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

PUBLIC HEARINGS

Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

22 Ord 26-38 Administrative Ordinance establishing a Qualifications and Examining Committee for the position of Fire Chief pursuant to the provisions of Section 9.01(a) of the Administrative Code and Section 12.12.1 of the Saint Paul City Charter.

Councilmembers Johnson, Yang, and Kim spoke in favor.

Kyle Thornberg from St. Paul Firefighters Local 21 spoke during the public hearing.

Kim moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Laid over to August 26, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

23 RES PH 26-149 Approving the Establishment of the Como-Eustis Special Sanitary Sewer Availability Connection Charge District. Determining the Como-Eustis Special Sanitary Sewer Availability Connection Charge for Phase 1 and 2 Sewer Capacity Improvements (Ward 4, District 12).

Barbara Holmes, resident, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Coleman to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

24 RES PH 26-158 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Department of Parks and Recreation in the amount of $633,224 to reflect remaining bond issued interest proceeds received from the Saint Paul Port Authority for the EAB Capital Project.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

25 RES PH 26-194 Amending the City's Capital Improvement Budget and Operating Budget to reflect the final sale details resulting from the issuance of the G.O. Capital Improvement Bonds, Series 2026B and the G.O. Street Reconstruction Bonds, Series 2026C.

3 people spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

26 RES PH 26-197 Authorizing the Police Department to accept the second amendment to the sub-grant agreement from the Saint Paul and Ramsey County Domestic Abuse Intervention Project and add grant activity budget.

2 people spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Johnson moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Councilmember Bowie gave remarks and asked to suspend the rules to allow for public comment on police surveillance.

Dan Stahley, Assistant City Attorney, stated that public hearings need to be duly

noticed.

Bowie asked for a public hearing to be scheduled.

Councilmember Yang expressed openness to scheduling a separate public hearing.

Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

27 RES PH 26-198 Approving the application of Anderson Race Management, on behalf of MN Recovery Connection, for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for the Walk for Recovery event on Saturday, September 12, 2026, at 75 Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Blvd - Minnesota State Capitol Grounds.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

28 RES PH 26-200 Approving the application of Nativity of Our Lord Catholic Church for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for Nativity County Fair event on Friday, September 18, Saturday, September 19, and Sunday, September 20, 2026, at 1900 Stanford Avenue - Nativity of Our Lord Catholic School grounds.

Nick Strauss from Nativity Church spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

29 RES PH 26-209 Ratifying the assessment for the Mill and Overlay for Front Avenue from Rice to Western, as part of the 2024 Mill and Overlay Program (Project No. MO2306, Assessment No. 245506).

Councilmember Yang moved to continue the public hearing to October 7, 2026.

Public hearing continued to October 7, 2026

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

LEGISLATIVE HEARING DISCUSSION ITEMS

30 RLH TA 26-155 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 565 ALDINE STREET (AKA 571 ALDINE STREET). (File No. J2611B, Assessment No. 268116)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Laura Schroeder, property manager, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Coleman moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

33 RLH TA 26-152 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 99 CALIFORNIA AVENUE WEST (AKA 100 CALIFORNIA AVENUE WEST). (File No. J2612B, Assessment No. 268118)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Zach Campbell, facilities manager, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Kim moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Moermond answered questions from Kim.

Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

39 RLH RR 26-16 Amending Second Making finding on the appealed substantial abatement ordered for 947 FREMONT AVENUE in Council File RLH RR 25-34. (Public hearing closed and laid over from August 19, 2026)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Jay Mitchell, property representative, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Johnson moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Moermond answered questions from Johnson.

Johnson moved to lay over for two weeks.

Public hearing closed and laid over to September 2, 2026

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

44 RLH SAO 26-50 Making finding on the appealed of Gary Grimes to a nuisance abatement ordered for 314 WYOMING STREET EAST in Council File RLH SAO 26-46. (Public hearing closed and laid over from August 19, 2026)

Laid over for one week.

Gary Grimes, property owner, appeared in person

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer: The original vehicle abatement order for this case was issued in May 2026. I recommended to grant to June 5, 2026. A follow-up resolution was heard in Legislative Hearings in early July and went to Council in mid July. The vehicles were not all gone at that time. This is a rental property and Gary Grimes is the owner. He has been working with the tenant to remove the vehicles. You granted an additional month to abate the nuisance. I don't know what the owner's ask is, but my recommendation is to find that the nuisance is not abated and authorize the Department of Safety and Inspections (DSI) to abate the nuisance.

Councilmember Yang: What is the current deadline?

Moermond: My recommendation is that the deadline has passed and that DSI be authorized to abate.

Gary Grimes, property owner: The problem with this last vehicle was that it didn't have

a title on it. The owner lives in London, England. I got a title sent from his sister that was supposed to be sent to my address, but I had to go to Shakopee. To get rid of it, most places need the title so they can get money out of it by reselling it. I've called a couple places to pick it up. One says they can pick up on Monday if I call them back today, otherwise Tuesday is the soonest they could pick it up.

Yang moved to close the public hearing. Approved 6-0.

Yang: How much time are you asking for?

Grimes: Until next Tuesday, though it may get picked up on Monday.

Yang: Because this is a Ward 2 item, and because of the testimony, I will move to lay this over for one week. Hopefully the car is gone by then.

Public hearing closed and laid over to August 26, 2026

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

36 RLH VO 26-33 Appeal of Bambi Barclay to a Correction Notice (which includes vacate order) at 1103 CHATSWORTH STREET NORTH.

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report.

Bambi Barclay, property owner, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Kim moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Moermond addressed questions from Kim.

Kim moved to grant to October 15, 2026 for compliance by way of restoration of utilities.

Councilmember Bowie spoke in favor.

Adopted as amended (granted to October 15, 2026)

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

35 RLH RR 26-14 Ordering the rehabilitation or razing and removal of the structures at 914 CENTRAL AVENUE WEST within fifteen (15) days after the August 19, 2026, City Council Public Hearing. (Refer to September 15, 2026 on condition)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report and answered

councilmember questions.

Councilmember Bowie moved to refer to September 15, 2026 Legislative Hearing.

Referred to September 15, 2026 Legislative Hearing

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Noecker

31 RLH TA 26-147 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 2195 BENSON AVENUE. (File No. CG25Q4B2-1, Assessment No. 260146)

Adopted

32 RLH TA 26-153 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1654 BUSH AVENUE. (File No. 2605T, Assessment No. 269005)

Adopted

34 RLH SAO 26-64 Making finding of Tami Richardson to the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 1547 CARROLL AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-55.

Adopted

37 RLH TA 26-145 Deleting the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 2012 COMO AVENUE. (File No. J2611B, Assessment No. 268116)

Adopted

38 RLH TA 26-149 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 865 DEALTON STREET. (File No. CG25Q4B2-2, Assessment No. 260149)

Adopted

40 RLH SAO 26-74 Making finding on the appeal of Mark Puchala II to a nuisance abatement ordered for 2016 FREMONT AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-59.

Adopted as amended (appeal denied, matter resolved)

41 RLH TA 26-150 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 790 ROSE AVENUE EAST. (File No. CG25Q4B4-2, Assessment No. 260140)

Adopted

42 RLH SAO 26-70 Appeal of Delmy L. Muniz to a Summary Abatement Order and Vehicle Abatement Order at 1689 STILLWATER AVENUE.

Adopted

43 RLH RSA 26-15 Appeal of Corey Johnson to a Rent Stabilization Determination at 200 WINTHROP STREET S.

Adopted

45 RLH TA 26-148 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 847 YORK AVENUE. (File No. CG25Q4B4-1, Assessment No. 260148)

Adopted

46 RLH AR 26-44 Ratifying the assessment for Securing and/or Emergency Boarding fees billed during March 2026 on Private Property. (File No. J2611B, Assessment No. 268116)

Adopted

47 RLH AR 26-45 Ratifying the assessment for Securing and/or Emergency Boarding fees billed during November 2025 at 701 4TH STREET EAST. (File No. J2607B2, Assessment No. 268117)

Adopted

48 RLH AR 26-46 Ratifying the assessment for Securing and/or Emergency Boarding fees billed during April 2026 on Private Property. (File No. J2612B, Assessment No. 268118)

Adopted

49 RLH AR 26-50 Ratifying the assessment for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of May 2026. (File No. J2607C, Assessment No. 262006)

Public hearing continued to September 2, 2026

50 RLH AR 26-65 Ratifying the assessment for Removal of Diseased and/or Dangerous Tree(s) service during February to April 2026. (File No. 2605T, Assessment No. 269005)

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:54 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
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